

# NIGHTCRAWLER

*Demonic face of the X-Men*



Although Nightcrawler looks like a demon, he is actually a deeply religious Catholic who studied for the priesthood.

Kurt Wagner is the son of AZAZEL, a mutant who resembles a demon, and the shapeshifting mutant MYSTIQUE. When Kurt was born in Bavaria, Mystique posed as an ordinary human and married a German baron, Eric Wagner. The local populace was horrified by newborn Kurt's demonic appearance: he had pointed ears, three fingers on each hand, two toes on each foot, and a tail. Pursued by a mob, Mystique threw the infant down a waterfall.

## CIRCUS FREAK

Azazel saved the baby, who was raised by gypsy sorceress Margali

Szardos. Kurt grew up in a Bavarian circus where Szardos was a fortune-teller. The circus performers accepted Kurt as part of their family. His best friend was Szardos's son Stefan, and Kurt fell in love with her daughter Jimaine. With his great agility, Wagner became the circus's star acrobat and trapeze performer. Audiences assumed that his inhuman appearance was merely a costume.

However, when Texas millionaire Amos Jardine bought the circus, he insisted that Wagner be exhibited as a freak. Outraged, Wagner quit the circus. Two nights later he battled Szardos's son Stefan, who had become a serial killer, and accidentally killed him. Believing Wagner was a demon



Charles Xavier of the X-Men arrives just in time to save Nightcrawler from a lynch mob.



Nightcrawler briefly used an image inducer to make himself look like a normal person.

Nightcrawler appears out of nowhere in a puff of smoke

and responsible for the murders, a mob would have killed Wagner, but Charles Xavier (see PROFESSOR X) arrived and mobilized the crowd with his telepathic powers. Xavier recruited Wagner to his second team of X-MEN, Wagner taking the name "Nightcrawler." He was reunited with Jimaine, now calling herself Amanda Sefton, and was reconciled with Margali Szardos, who had blamed him for Stefan's death.

After serving in the X-Men for years, Nightcrawler became a founding member of EXCALIBUR. He studied to become a priest but was never ordained.

Nightcrawler learned the identities of his parents, and discovered that Mystique's foster daughter ROGUE is his foster sister. He met his half-brothers Nils Styger, alias ABYSS, and KIWI BLACK, and together they defeated Azazel. On his latest return to the X-Men, new member PIXIE stabbed him with her soul dagger, which revealed that MAGIK's Soulsword had been hidden inside of him. With his help, the X-Men then managed to free Magik from Limbo. He is currently with the X-Men in their San Francisco headquarters. **PS, MF**

## FACTFILE

### REAL NAME

Kurt Wagner

### OCCUPATION

Adventurer

### BASE

The Xavier Institute, Salem Center, New York State

### HEIGHT

5 ft 9 in

### WEIGHT

195 lbs

### EYES

Yellow, no visible pupils

### HAIR

Indigo

### FIRST APPEARANCE

Giant-Size X-Men #1 (May 1975)

NIGHTCRAWLER

POWERS

Mutant power to teleport himself, his clothing, and a limited amount of additional mass, by traveling through another dimension.

When he teleports, part of the atmosphere of that dimension escapes onto Earth, accompanied by a "bamf" sound and the smell of brimstone.

## ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

### • X-Men Vol. 1 Annual #4

Margali Szardos seeks vengeance on Nightcrawler for killing her son.

### • Nightcrawler #1-4

Nightcrawler journeys through various dimensions in a quest to return to earth.

### • X-Men Unlimited Vol. 1 #4

Nightcrawler learns that Mystique is his mother.

### • X-Men: Days of Future Past, tpb

Turns the spotlight on Nightcrawler's interesting origins.